PRODUCT STRATEGY & OPERATIONS LEADER

Ada Johnson

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Product Strategy & Operations leader with 20 years of experience at Airbnb, Google, Target, and Best Buy. I find the problems nobody owns, build the systems that fix them, and make sure they worked. My edge: I make the people closest to the problem, frontline teams and customers, impossible to ignore.

CAREER ARC

Staying Close to the Customer → Learning How to Scale → Building Systems That Fix Problems

CORE CAPABILITIES

Product Strategy & Operations | AI Workflows & Automation | Support & Frontline Operations | Feedback Systems | Operating Models | Voice of Customer | Go-to-Market Strategy | Strategic Partnerships

EXPERIENCE

AIRBNB · 2023 – Present

Product Strategy & Operations | Global Fraud & Safety

Manager, Product Operations (2023 – 2026) → Manager, Project Implementation (2026 – Present)

Led Product Strategy & Operations for Airbnb's global Fraud & Safety operations. Built and led a team of 4 connecting frontline signals to Product and Engineering across 70+ enforcement workflows (identity, safety, financial fraud, account integrity).

- Built Fraud & Safety's frontline feedback loop, using AI for the first pass: turned 1,360+ agent reports into 1,102 problems and 46 prioritized clusters, assigned an owner to 91%, and shipped 20 fixes in 3.5 months for issues that had waited a median of 8.5 months
- Proved what gets problems fixed: items with a named owner shipped 46% of the time, versus 2% without one
- Fixes surfaced through the loop helped recover about 2,000 agent hours a month in the largest queue (75% of volume, handle time down 36%) and cut weekly escalations 57% in another
- Changed how Fraud & Safety measures operational health: designed the prototype Analytics rebuilt as the Queue Health Monitor (QHM), now the official source of truth for weekly and monthly business reviews across all 5 domains; credited by name at launch, it replaced a manual scorecard
- Developed my team to own business reviews by building AI workflows for root-cause analysis and prep that freed about 20 hours a week
- Now lead a team of 6 in Airbnb's newly formed Scaled Services org, resolving who owns what across implementation, policy, and operations, and building how we measure whether an implementation actually succeeds, not just whether it ships

GOOGLE · 2021 – 2023

Strategy & Product Operations Principal | Google Technology & Engineering

Led strategy and transformation initiatives for Google's global frontline technology support organization, redesigning operating models to improve scalability, efficiency, and workforce sustainability.

- Co-led the redesign of Google's 800+ person frontline IT support org across 7 locations, including the business case that converted 250+ contractors to full-time roles, aligning Engineering, Finance, HR, and Legal; 249 of 252 offers accepted (98.8%)
- Broke through months of stalled decision-making, aligning leadership on the new model in under two months

GOOGLE · 2019 – 2021

Strategy & Product Operations Lead | Google One Partnerships

Led global partner strategy and operations for Google One, scaling a consumer subscription product through telecommunications, OEM, and retail partnerships.

- Launched and managed 11+ of Google One's 40+ global partnerships, reaching 89M+ users and driving 72% of partner-channel trial starts in under 10 months
- Built the partner playbook that cut onboarding time in half and became the standard for every launch after it
- Grew the largest partnership, Chromebooks, to about 53% trial-to-paid; partners were a key channel in Google One's 95% subscription growth

FOUNDATIONAL EXPERIENCE

GOOGLE · 2016 – 2019

Product Planning Lead, Google Store · General Manager, West Hollywood Pop-Up · Global Program Manager, Google Merchandise Store

- Grew Merchandise Store revenue 43% over two years on a $14M global program across 48 countries; introduced Google hardware, adding $9M incremental revenue and 81K+ device sales
- Directed 40+ staff to launch Google's first LA pop-up store, beating sales and conversion targets by 5%; created 10+ hardware business plans connecting customer insight to financial opportunity

TARGET CORPORATION · 2012 – 2015

Senior Buyer, Infant & Toddler Furniture · Senior Product Manager, Global Sourcing

- Turned a declining $75M category to +20% year over year; delivered $4M in annual cost savings on a $90M owned-brand sourcing portfolio

BEST BUY CORPORATION · 2006 – 2012

Merchant & Category Strategy | Various Categories

- Co-developed a $5M Batman: Arkham City launch campaign that generated $10M in first-week revenue

LEADERSHIP

- Co-Founder & Lead Organizer, Black in Product Operations @ Google
- Former Alumni Board President & Guest Lecturer, UMN College of Design
- NCAA Division I Track & Field, University of Minnesota (Alumna)

EDUCATION

- MBA, Business Entrepreneurship, Bethel University, Saint Paul, Minnesota
- BS, Retail Merchandising & Business Management, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities